

Pancho and Lefty - rev. 6-2-2026

Writer: Townes Van Zant / Artist: Emmylou Harris (or Willie Nelson & Merle Haggard)

Tempo: 115

Main strum: d- du -u du (Island Strum)

Intro use Split Island Strum: "d- du -u" is on [C] and the last "d" is on [F]

INTRO

C /// F / C /// F / C /// F / C /// F /

- - - -

VERSE 1

C G
' Living' on the road my friend, ' was gonna keep you free and clean
F C G
' Now you wear your skin like iron, your breath's as hard as kerosene
F C F
' You weren't your mamma's only boy, but her favorite one it seems
Am F / C / G
She began to cry when you said good- bye,
F Am +riff G /
And sank into your dreams (2,3,4,1,2,3)

VERSE 2

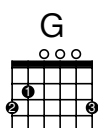
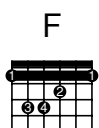
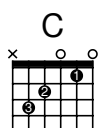
C G
' Pancho was a bandit boys, his horse was fast as polished steel
F C G
' He wore his gun outside his pants, for all the honest world to feel
F C F
Pancho met his match you know, in the desert down in Mexico
Am F / C / G
' And no one heard his dy- ing words,
F Am +riff
But that's the way it goes (2,3,4,1,2,3,4)

CHORUS 2

F C F
' All the Federales say, ' we could have had him any day
Am F / C / G
' We only let him slip a-way,
F Am G /
out of kindness I sup-pose (2,3,4,1,2,3)

VERSE 3

C G
' Lefty he can't sing the blues, all night long like he used to
F C G
' The dust that Pancho bit down south, ended up in Lefty's mouth
F C F
' The day they laid poor Pancho low, Lefty split for Ohio
Am F / C / G
' Where he got the bread to go,



F $Am + riff$
 There ain't nobody knows (2,3,4,1,2,3,4)

Riff

	[Am]		[Am]
A	-3-2-3-2-3-2-0- - -	- - - - - - - - - - - - -	
E	- - - - - - - - - - 3-	-0- - - 0- - - 0- - - -	
C	- - - - - - - - - - -	- - - 2- - - 2- - - 2-0-2-	
G	- - - - - - - - - - -	- - - - - - - - - - - - -	

CHORUS 3

F *C* *F*
' All the Federales say, ' we could have had him any day
Am *F/* *C/* *G*
' We only let him slip a-way,
F *Am +riff* *G/*
out of kindness I sup- pose (2,3,4,1,2,3)

VERSE 4

C *G*
' The poets tell how Pancho fell, ' Lefty's living in a cheap hotel
F *C* *G*
' The desert's quiet and Cleveland's cold, and so the story ends, we're told
F *C* *F*
' Pancho needs your prayers it's true, but save a few for Lefty too
Am *F/* *C/* *G*
' He only did what he had to do,
F *Am +riff*
And now he's growing old (2,3,4,1,2,3,4)

CHORUS 4

F *C* *F*
' A few grey Federales say, ' could have had him any day
Am *F/* *C/* *G*
' We only let him drift a-way,
F *Am +riff*
out of kindness I sup- pose (2,3,4,1,2,3,4)

OUTRO

F *C* *F*
' A few grey Federales say, ' could have had him any day
Am *F/* *C/* *G*
' We only let him go so long,
F *Am +riff* *Am / G /*
out of kindness I sup- pose (2,3,4,1,2)
C /
(hold)

Riff

	[Am]	[Am]
A	-3-2-3-2-3-2-0----	-----
E	-----3-	-0---0---0-----
C	-----	---2---2---2-0-2-
G	-----	-----

